

1 GAME OVERVIEW

OBJECTIVE: Build the dominant colony and finish with the most Colony Points.

PLAYERS: 1-5 (standard competitive reference focuses on 3-5).

PLAY TIME: About 60-90 minutes.

WINNING: Score through territory, collection sites, battles, complete ant bodies, Colony Goals, and final resource majorities.

2 SETUP CHRONOLOGY

- A. Place The Great Tunnel centrally; put the Score Track beside the play area.
- B. Each player takes a Nest Mat, all 36 cubes of one color, and the matching Player Marker.
- C. Each player places 5 cubes in the Larvae Chamber, 1 ant in The Great Tunnel, and the marker at Start.
- D. Give each player 2 food and 2 cards. Put remaining cubes beside the Nest Mat.
- E. Shuffle standard hexes face down. For a first game, remove Beyond the Meadow hexes 21-25.
- F. Randomly select 2 starting hexes per player; shuffle and place them face down atop the standard stack.
- G. Place food and centipede/wormhole tokens within reach. Put Round Marker on Round 1 (Early Spring).
- H. Randomly choose the Starting Player and give that player the Active Player Marker.

REMEMBER

The Meadow begins with The Great Tunnel only. Starting hexes are on top of the draw stack, not placed.

3 STRUCTURE OF A ROUND

1 WORKER PHASE

Take one action per turn: Explore, March, Forage, Play a Card, or Rest. Other players may take the matching Reaction. Ends when 2 players Rest.



2 SOLDIER PHASE

Resolve head bonuses, then contested hexes in number order. Centipede battle occurs before ant battle in the same hex.



3 QUEEN PHASE

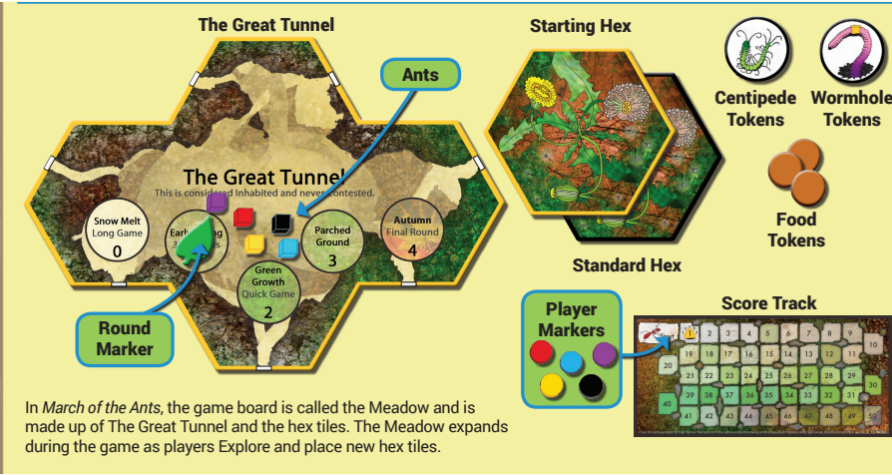
Resolve abdomen bonuses. Harvest collection sites, feed ants, choose Royal Decree, then Slumber and score.



4 ADVANCE

Advance the Round Marker. After the final round, perform end-game scoring.

4 SETUP MAP & COMPONENT LEGEND



A Great Tunnel B Starting hexes C Standard stack D Tokens
E Score track F Round marker G Player markers H Ant cubes

1 KEY MECHANICS / RULES REFRESHER

WORKER ACTIONS

- Explore (1 food): place a hex adjacent to an inhabited hex with at least one connected tunnel; move 1+ ants into it. Reaction: place 1 larva in an inhabited hex.
- March (1 food): up to 5 steps; move larvae first, then ants. Larvae enter only inhabited hexes and immediately become ants. Reaction: move 1 ant 1 step.
- Forage (1 food): draw 2 cards. Reaction: gain 1 larva.
- Play a Card: pay its cost with larvae and/or ants. Reaction: discard 1 card to draw 1.
- Rest: not normally your first action. First Rest gains 1 larva; later Rests gain 1 food. After Rest, keep Resting but may React.

HEXES & MOVEMENT

- Inhabit = at least 1 ant on a collection site. Control = occupy the control site.
- Ants entering an empty site inhabit it immediately; if all sites are full, place them in the outskirts.
- Contested = 2+ players present and at least 1 ant in outskirts. Shared hexes without outskirts do not battle.
- Wormhole to wormhole costs 1 step. Wormholes cannot be used to Explore. The Great Tunnel never battles.

BATTLE QUICK STEPS

- 1. Army Strength = ants in hex + head evolutions. 2. Each side may add one Ferocity card. 3. Highest total wins; defender wins ties.
- Casualties use Army Strength, not Ferocity: loser loses winner strength; winner loses half loser strength, rounded down. Winner keeps a lone survivor.
- Winner gains 1 Colony Point and may occupy empty sites. Ants win ties against centipedes.

QUEEN PHASE

- Harvest every inhabited collection site. Feed: 1 food feeds 4 ants, plus 1 per abdomen evolution. Then use larvae 1-for-1; destroy remaining unfed ants.
- Royal Decree: choose 2 food or 5 larvae; none in final round. Slumber scores Inner Meadow control and Colony Goals.

2 SCORING SUMMARY

DURING PLAY

Battle win: 1 CP. Colony Point site: collect during Harvest. Cards: as printed. Complete ant body: 3 CP.

EACH SLUMBER

1 CP per controlled Inner Meadow hex adjacent to The Great Tunnel. Score each fulfilled Colony Goal.

END GAME

Largest Brood: 3 CP for most larvae. Greatest Stores: 3 CP for most food. Untold Potential: 3 CP for most cards in hand.

TIES FOR REWARDS

Each tied player gains 1 CP instead of 3 CP.

WINNER

Most Colony Points. Overall tie: most ants in the Meadow.

4 END OF GAME

- The standard game ends after Slumber in the final round.
- Award all three end-game resource majorities. Resolve tied majorities as 1 CP each.
- Total Colony Points. Highest score wins.
- If tied, the tied player with the most ants in the Meadow wins.

3 STRATEGIC TIPS

GOOD HABITS

- Secure food sites early; actions and feeding both consume food.
- Keep larvae available for reactions, cards, and emergency feeding.
- Plan the Queen Phase before expanding your ant count.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Do not place March larvae into a hex you do not inhabit.
- Do not trigger battle in a shared hex unless an ant is in the outskirts.
- Do not add Ferocity values when calculating casualties.
- Do not forget the Royal Decree is skipped in the final round.

COMPETITIVE TIPS

- Rest timing can determine next round's Starting Player.
- Complete ant bodies for 3 CP, but only the top evolution in each section grants its printed ability.
- Control sites win battle ties and score Inner Meadow hexes.
- Watch final larvae, food, and hand-size majorities before the last Slumber.

FAST CHECK BEFORE SLUMBER

Harvested all sites? Fed every ant? Chosen Decree?
Scored Inner Meadow and Goals?